

Introduction to OpenClaw

Course Overview

This course will introduce the basic concepts of OpenClaw, helping you quickly understand what OpenClaw is, its core features, and its unique advantages. Through this course, you will gain a preliminary understanding of OpenClaw and lay the foundation for further in-depth learning.

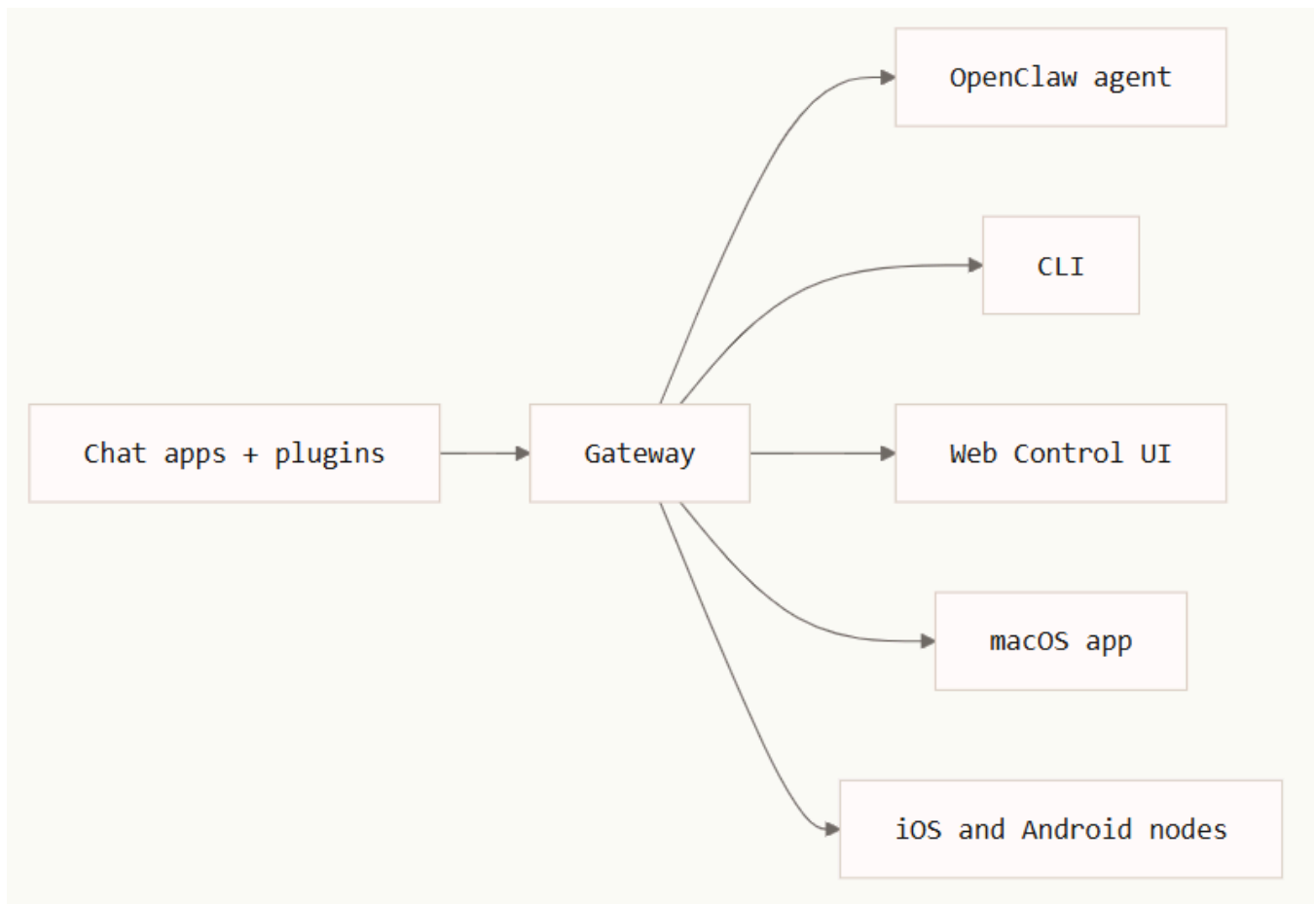
Course Content

- Understand the definition and core value of OpenClaw
- Master the key features and characteristics of OpenClaw

1. What is OpenClaw



OpenClaw is a **self-hosted gateway** that connects your favorite chat apps and channel surfaces — built-in channels plus bundled or external channel plugins such as Discord, Google Chat, iMessage, Matrix, Microsoft Teams, Signal, Slack, Telegram, WhatsApp, Zalo, and more — to AI coding agents. You run a single Gateway process on your own machine (or a server), and it becomes the bridge between your messaging apps and an always-available AI assistant.



2. Core Features

- **Multi-channel Support:** A single Gateway can connect to multiple chat channels simultaneously
- **Session Management:** Creates independent sessions for each sender, maintaining coherent context
- **Agent-native:** Specifically designed for coding agents, supporting tool usage, sessions, memory, and multi-agent routing
- **Self-hosted:** Runs on local hardware, with full control over your data

Multi-channel gateway

Discord, iMessage, Signal, Slack, Telegram, WhatsApp, WebChat, and more with a single Gateway process.

Plugin channels

Bundled plugins add Matrix, Nostr, Twitch, Zalo, and more in normal current releases.

Multi-agent routing

Isolated sessions per agent, workspace, or sender.

Media support

Send and receive images, audio, and documents.

Web Control UI

Browser dashboard for chat, config, sessions, and nodes.

Mobile nodes

Pair iOS and Android nodes for Canvas, camera, and voice-enabled workflows.

3. Unique Advantages

Feature	Description
Self-hosted	runs on your hardware, your rules
Multi-channel	one Gateway serves built-in channels plus bundled or external channel plugins simultaneously
Agent-native	built for coding agents with tool use, sessions, memory, and multi-agent routing

4. Summary

OpenClaw provides developers and advanced users with a convenient, secure, and controllable way to use AI assistants. By connecting various chat channels, it makes it possible to communicate with AI agents anytime and anywhere, while maintaining complete control over your data.